

What you can do with Terapin

■ Convert VHS to VCD

If you have some precious home videos or movies on video tape, you might want to ensure a longer life for them by transferring them to the more reliable CD medium.

■ Record live TV broadcasts

This is where the Terapin really emulates the VCR. You can record your favourite TV programmes, or maybe the World Cup Finals onto a CD and enjoy it over and over again.

■ Digitise and edit home videos

You can now transfer videos from your camcorder or another video source and convert it into the ready-to-edit digital format. Use a video editing tool to edit and manipulate them.

■ Create audio CDs

Compile your own Top of the Pops collection CDs by recording directly from any audio source, and even from TV or VCD.

■ Audio and video playback

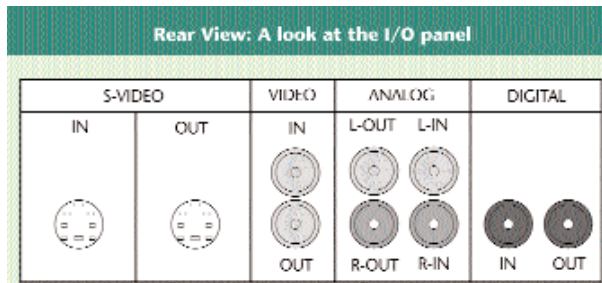
Use it as a player for your home entertainment system. Whether it's movies on VCD or the latest Metalli-ca album, the Terapin plays it all.

The best part about the Terapin is that it is the first home recording device that lets you record audio and video directly to a versatile digital media such as the CD. While PC users with the right kind of hardware (video capture cards) have been able to record video on CDs, the Terapin delivers this functionality to everyone in a single device. It does not need any third-party software; users don't need a PC to record or play music and movies. Everything good comes at a cost, of course. Terapin comes at Rs 29,000.

Like the VCRs that most of us are familiar with, Terapin works well with a variety of analog sources such as Cable TVs, VCRs, as well as digital sources such as Camcorders, Hi-Fi music systems, and so on. It is media-friendly and it allows you to use the re-writeable CD-RW media too.

Taking versatility further, the CDs that Terapin records, run without a fuss on any CD/VCD player or computer, irrespective of whether you have used CD-R or CD-RW media. While testing, we faced no compatibility issues with the Terapin, which speaks volumes in this standards-plagued age.

The Terapin, like any other VCR, also comes with a fully functional remote control. The only difference is that the



The Terapin's rear panel resembles that of a traditional VCR and in addition it also includes digital in/out ports

Terapin remote control has probably every single function that the main panel has, right at your fingertips.

Aiming for perfection

While it might be asking for too much, there are still a couple of things that we would love to see incorporated into the Terapin. First of all, adding the option of MP3 Playback would make Terapin a complete modern home entertainment system. Including preset recording modes will ensure auto-finalisation of a

CD-R as soon as the CD nears completion. Perhaps the most important factor would be enabling on-the-fly MPEG-4 compression. Enabling this using hardware could be relatively easy and would allow recording of nearly 2 hours of video content on a 700-MB CD-R instead of the current 60-minute limit, without any reduction in quality.

Lastly, another wonderful addition to the Terapin would be the inclusion of a TV Tuner module. This would allow the routing of cable TV signals directly through the Terapin. The ability to then tune or program channels directly from within the Terapin would make it the ultimate VCR replacement.

Apart from that, the Terapin is the most perfect recording and playback device in the market. No reason why you shouldn't go Terapin'ing, if you don't mind the cost, that is. ■

HATIM KANTAWALLA

Your VCR's Successor

PARAMETERS	TRADITIONAL VCR	TERAPIN VIDEO RECORDER
Input device	TV, VCR, camcorders	TV, VCR, DVD/VCD player, camcorder, DV camcorders, audio systems
Output to	TV, VCR	TV, VCR, DVD/VCD player, camcorder, DV camcorders, audio systems
Output media	VHS tapes	CD-R/RW discs
Playback Duration	VHS tapes in 90, 180, 240 minute variants	CD-R/RW allows 60 minutes of video or 74 minutes of audio
Compatibility	VCRs	VCD/DVD players, PC, MAC, audio systems
Scheduling/programmability	Scheduling of channel, time and duration specific recording	No such functionality; everything is manual

Want to own a Terapin?

You can buy the Terapin in India through Monarch Video Vision by sending an e-mail at viren@bom2.vsnl.net.in or calling 022-2619022.